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Response for the American Empire

This discussion will talk about how William McKinley justified the control of the Philippines from the texts of "William McKinley on American Expansionism" and picture "School Begins". To start off, the Philippines were a strategic military position during the Spanish-American War, occupying it temporarily to prevent the Spanish from making a counter attack. The spoils of war gave the Philippines to the US and the question of what to do with them was in the hands of the president. Keeping the territory was unpopular because it spread the idea that the US was imperialistic, which directly contradicted the values of America being a democratic, and peaceful country. It resonated the slippery slope idea of America consuming the world and that the Philippines was the stepping stone. Contrary to this, the picture of "School Begins" shows a class room depicting the island nations as dirty and uneducated children while the states are educated. Uncle Sam is there as a teacher trying to teach the island nations how to be civil. The idea of the US not being Imperialism is pushed aside for the idea that the US has a moral responsibility of uplifting, educating and Christianizing the population. The two ideas really conflicted with McKinley taking him several days to think and taking thought from both political parties before deciding to add the Philippines to the United States. The idea that taking territories from less prosperous peoples is not new. Similar thinking happened with the Native Americans and the Mexicans in taking their territories.